CTRL FREAKS / RWANDA CIVIL REGISTRATION & VITAL STATISTICS / 2019–2025

Every life, counted.

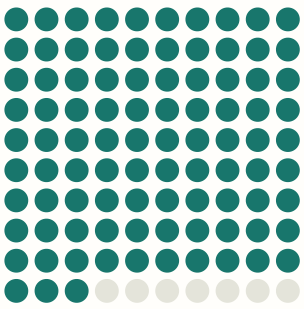
Rwanda registers more than nine in ten expected births, but only about half of expected deaths. Seven years of data show where that gap is closing.

Live births registered
356,838
+13.9% since 2019

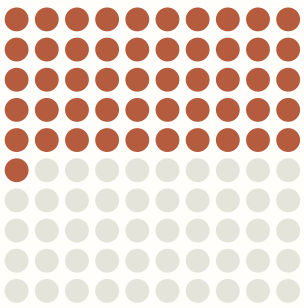
Deaths registered
39,355
+65.4% since 2019, as coverage widened

Marriages registered
50,256
+3.6% since 2019

Divorces registered
4,479
2,629 of them granted in 2025



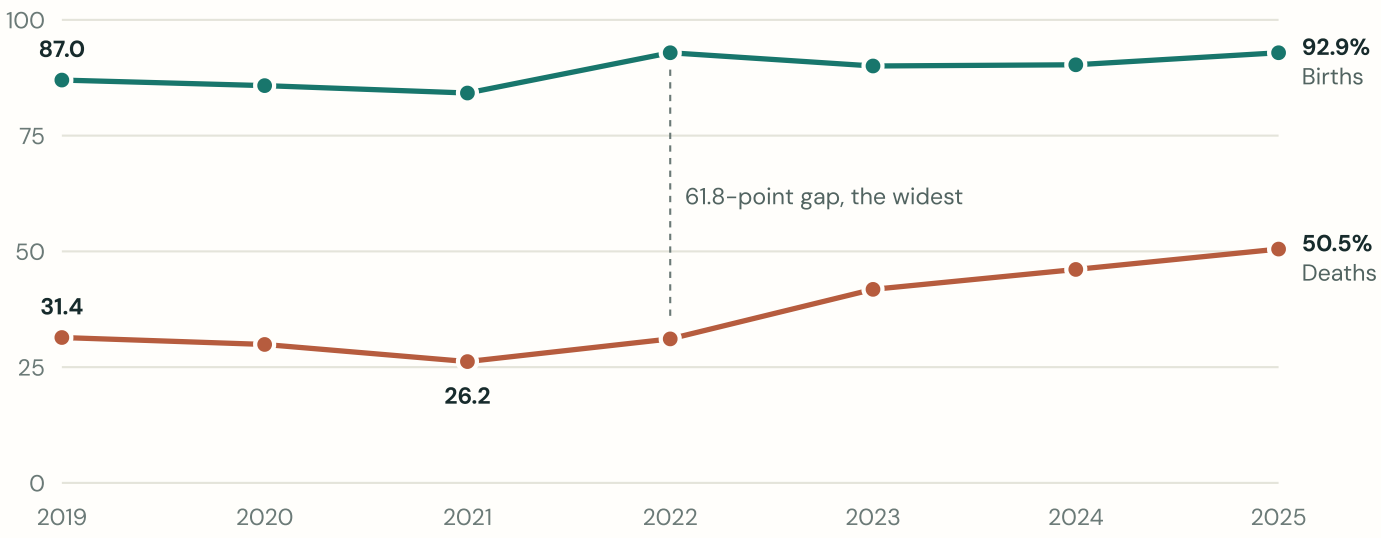
92.9%
of estimated births were registered in 2025: 356,838 of about 384,279.



50.5%
of estimated deaths were registered in 2025: 39,355 of about 77,875.

The gap is closing, but only recently

Registration completeness, % of estimated events



THE COVERAGE GAP, 2025

42.4
percentage points

Births are recorded far more completely than deaths. The gap reached 61.8 points in 2022 and has narrowed every year since.

Births have levelled off. 92.9% matches the 2022 level, after dipping near 90%.

Deaths are driving the change, up from a low of 26.2% in 2021.

Speed has slipped. Deaths registered on time fell from 97.7% in 2023 to 89.9%, while births held at 99.1%.

Women's deaths are counted less. Completeness is 43.7% for women and 57.6% for men.

Births

Where life begins

97.8%
of registered births took place in a health facility

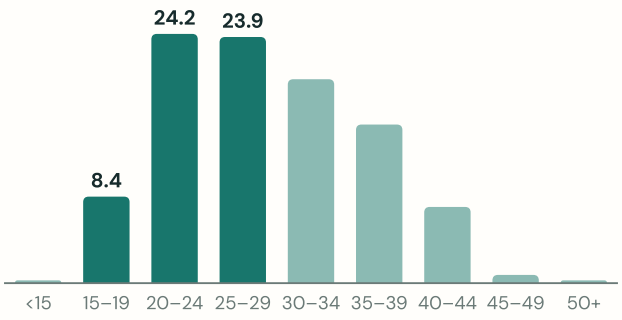
3.8 → 3.5
births per woman, 2019 to 2025 (adjusted)

8.5%
of births were to mothers under 20

8.1%
low birth weight, up from 7.4% in 2019

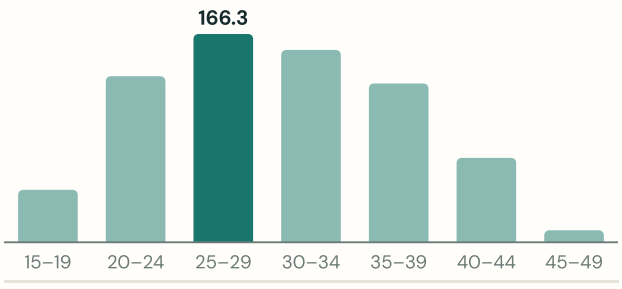
One in four births is to a mother aged 20–24

Share of registered births by mother's age, %



Fertility itself peaks later, at 25–29

Adjusted births per 1,000 women, by age



More births are registered, yet the adjusted birth rate fell from 29.1 to 27.2 per 1,000 people. Counts and rates tell different stories.

Deaths

Seeing what we lose

55.9%
of registered deaths happened in the community

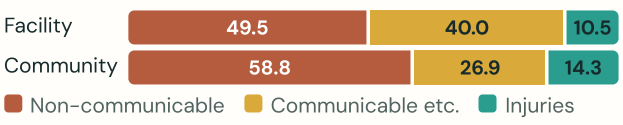
38.5 → 32.7
under-5 deaths per 1,000 live births, 2019 to 2025 (adjusted)

14,997
of 17,345 facility deaths were medically certified

18,921
verbal autopsies recorded causes for community deaths

Non-communicable disease leads in both settings

Share of usable causes of death, %



The leading causes differ by setting

Top five recorded causes, 2025

#	Health facility		Community	
1	Conditions arising during the perinatal period	14.9%	Other and unspecified cardiac diseases	16.2%
2	Lower respiratory infections	6.0%	Acute cardiac disease	11.1%
3	Cerebrovascular disease	4.3%	Digestive neoplasms	8.0%
4	Road traffic accidents	2.7%	Assault	5.3%
5	Diabetes mellitus	2.7%	HIV/AIDS related death	4.9%

These shares describe recorded causes, not all deaths in Rwanda. Adjusted crude death rate: 5.9 to 5.5 per 1,000. Usable causes: 82.3% in facilities, 83.9% in the community.

Marriage & divorce

Families form, families change

97.0%
of marriages chose community of property

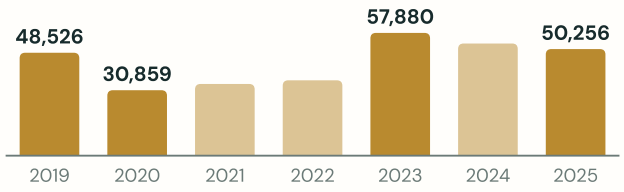
3.6
marriages per 1,000 people, from 3.9 in 2019

59%
of divorces registered in 2025 were also granted that year

39.8 / 43.3
average age at divorce, women / men

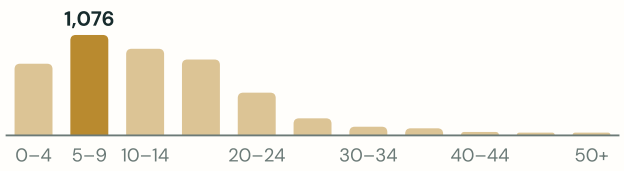
Marriage registration has swung widely

Registered marriages per year



The largest group divorced after 5–9 years

Registered divorces by length of marriage, 2025



Kigali City registers the most divorces

By wife's residence, 2025. By husband's, Kigali has 1,185.



Completeness is not timeliness.
Completeness compares recorded events with estimated events. Timeliness asks how many recorded events met the legal deadline.

More recorded deaths is not more dying.
Registered deaths rose as coverage widened, while the adjusted death rate edged down.

A count is not a risk.
Provinces differ in population, so divorce counts are not rates, and no count here is one person's probability.

Source: NISR, CRVS Final Tables 2025 (Figures 6, 7, 12, 15, 24, 25, 32; Tables 4, 9, 15, 16, 17, 18, 20, 24, 27, 28; 10.3, 10.5). Expected events and adjusted rates are NISR estimates. The published 2025 factsheet prints 50,236 marriages; the final tables give 50,256.

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